

Week 15: Agency

BIG IDEA

Agency is the ability to choose, a God-given privilege and responsibility that points to his existence. Students are challenged to see that free will points us to God and should reflect him. This week, leaders take the temperature of their community: is it still safe, loving, and challenging?

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- So many questions about why things happen are answered simply by humanity's God-given ability to make choices, which govern so much of our lives.
- Students are challenged with two things: our free will points us to God, and our free will should reflect him in how we behave.
- After last week's temperature check on students, this week check your community: is it the open, loving, safe place set as the overarching goal?
- Ask whether leaders foster the right atmosphere of discussion where questions are welcome, with grace, love, and truth, and no one student dominating.
- Love and challenge go together; in the speaker's experience, the students he challenged most were the ones who felt most loved and valued.
- Check that students feel safe to be honest, that small groups serve and care for one another, and consider serving together in the community.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. How do our choices, good or bad, actually reflect God?
2. What does the fact that we have free will tell us about God's existence?
3. Do students in your group feel safe to be honest, even when honesty is hard?
4. Is one student dominating discussion, or is everyone invited to participate? What adjustment would help?

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